Market Brief - offline copy

Snapshot taken Friday 23 October 2026, 19:03 (Europe/Madrid). Data is frozen at that time. Links open the original articles when you are online.

Daily overview

Markets over the last day: the eight tracked equity indices moved -1.05% on average, with Nasdaq strongest (+0.05%) and Hang Seng weakest (-3.03%). Brent crude changed -1.62% to 111.34. Gold changed -1.10% to 4,015.6001. Bitcoin changed +0.41% to 81,646.3906. The US 10-year yield stands at 4.988%, a relative move of +0.71%. Among the firms tracked, Equinor (+5.06%) and ConocoPhillips (+4.08%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: How a transatlantic mega-merger fell apart over a leadership tug of war (FT World). Smith & Nephew was in talks to combine with J&J's orthopaedics unit but refused to agree to former CEO leading combined business Deals and capital markets: Could Anthropic's IPO be a turning point for AI? You asked, we answered (FT Markets). Tech writer at large Richard Waters and venture capital correspondent George Hammond replied to reader questions Central banks and macro: ECB on course for another rate rise in 2026 (FT World). Read the October scenario by the FT's Monetary Policy Radar team Central banks and macro: Oil hits $117 for first time since April on fears of flare-up in Iran hostilities (FT World). Rise in energy prices pushes US inflation expectations higher Geopolitics and trade: The limits of Trump's trade war (FT Home). Economies like Mexico are being forced to choose sides on trade

Weekly overview

Markets over the past seven days: the eight tracked equity indices moved -1.73% on average, with Dow Jones strongest (+0.58%) and Hang Seng weakest (-5.67%). Brent crude changed +1.35% to 111.34. Gold changed -3.96% to 4,015.6001. Bitcoin changed -0.45% to 81,646.3906. The US 10-year yield stands at 4.988%, a relative move of -2.16%. Among the firms tracked, Ares Management (+9.98%) and Blackstone (+9.52%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: How a transatlantic mega-merger fell apart over a leadership tug of war (FT World). Smith & Nephew was in talks to combine with J&J's orthopaedics unit but refused to agree to former CEO leading combined business Deals and capital markets: Buyout firm EQT acquires German diagnostics group in €10.8bn deal (FT Markets). Move for Germany's Qiagen is one of the largest take-private transactions in Europe this year Central banks and macro: UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise (FT World). Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting Central banks and macro: UK inflation and borrowing top forecasts in blow to Healey (FT World). Figure comes ahead of next week's Budget and will cement expectations of Bank of England rate rise in November Geopolitics and trade: Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches (FT Markets). Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

Major news by sector (past 7 days)

IPOs & Listings

Microsoft gives data centre hopefuls a pre-IPO reality check

FT Companies | 20 Oct 06:00

The US tech giant calling time on its Nscale deal exposes faultlines running through this fast-growing area of the AI sector

Ambani looks to pull off India's biggest IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 02:33

Jio Platforms aims to list at $107bn valuation amid stock market downturn, tougher competition and goading from Elon Musk

CVC explores bid for Verisure just one year after IPO

FT Markets | 21 Oct 19:43

Shares in Swedish-listed security group trading 30% below their price at flotation

Listings in south-east Asia gain momentum with $1bn IPO

FT Markets | 18 Oct 03:00

Owner of digital wallet GCash set to start trading in region’s biggest debut this year

Waiting for good IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 07:30

Anthropic’s shrinking window to list

M&A & Deals

How a transatlantic mega-merger fell apart over a leadership tug of war

FT World | 23 Oct 17:56

Smith & Nephew was in talks to combine with J&J’s orthopaedics unit but refused to agree to former CEO leading combined business

Buyout firm EQT acquires German diagnostics group in €10.8bn deal

FT Markets | 22 Oct 00:23

Move for Germany’s Qiagen is one of the largest take-private transactions in Europe this year

Private equity finds next Asian frontier

FT Markets | 19 Oct 03:30

Foreign firms make up majority of large buyout deals in continent’s fourth-biggest economy

Big private equity backers call for greater scrutiny of sweetheart deals

FT Markets | 22 Oct 06:00

Concern that investors are insufficiently prepared to challenge buyout firms on deals involving potential conflicts

Anthropic strikes deal to launch European consultancy

FT Markets | 23 Oct 11:04

New company backed by Anthropic and UK buyout group Hg will advise companies on how to deploy AI

Nestlé removes Russian business from accounts after Kremlin takeover

FT World | 22 Oct 09:55

Swiss group takes $1.95bn net assets from its balance sheet after presidential decree to control business

Private Equity, VC & Angels

Could Anthropic’s IPO be a turning point for AI? You asked, we answered

FT Markets | 22 Oct 17:00

Tech writer at large Richard Waters and venture capital correspondent George Hammond replied to reader questions

Private equity group Charlesbank closes one of the biggest law firm deals

FT Markets | 19 Oct 06:00

Stake in Wood Smith Henning & Berman could herald wave of investments in US liability defence firms

KKR accused by EU of misleading regulators over €22bn telecoms deal

FT Companies | 19 Oct 13:32

Private equity group disputes it gave false or misleading information to Brussels as it sought clearance for FiberCop deal

New York pensions chief says private equity firm sought to expense jet use

FT Markets | 19 Oct 23:18

Head of city’s $326bn Retirement Systems hits out at ‘steady creep’ higher in fees charged by managers

Banking

Goldman Sachs, JPMorgan and Morgan Stanley are dominating the AI stock boom. Here's their edge

CNBC | 21 Oct 17:30

Wall Street’s Big Three have generated $52 billion in equity trading revenue this year, capturing about 80% of the market on rising margin lending to hedge funds.

Robot factories and hypersonic missiles: JPMorgan Chase's first $5 billion of defense investments

CNBC | 19 Oct 14:34

With $5 billion already deployed off its balance sheet, JPMorgan Chase is racing ahead on direct investments in defense tech, hardware and supply chains.

Central Banks & Macro

UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise

FT World | 21 Oct 09:03

Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting

UK inflation and borrowing top forecasts in blow to Healey

FT World | 21 Oct 18:31

Figure comes ahead of next week’s Budget and will cement expectations of Bank of England rate rise in November

ECB on course for another rate rise in 2026

FT World | 22 Oct 15:30

Read the October scenario by the FT’s Monetary Policy Radar team

Hungary detains Orbán’s former central bank chief

FT World | 21 Oct 14:39

György Matolcsy and several others arrested in corruption probes targeting former PM’s circle of power

Oil hits $117 for first time since April on fears of flare-up in Iran hostilities

FT World | 23 Oct 19:01

Rise in energy prices pushes US inflation expectations higher

Turkey cuts interest rates despite $18bn investment funds scandal

FT World | 22 Oct 15:06

Central bank lowers benchmark rate to 36% as inflation eases

Geopolitics & Trade

Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches

FT Markets | 21 Oct 12:00

Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

The limits of Trump’s trade war

FT Home | 23 Oct 06:00

Economies like Mexico are being forced to choose sides on trade

Tehran’s cafés offer a brief escape from war and economic crisis

FT Companies | 23 Oct 06:00

Middle-class residents push back against social restrictions with some cafés even defying the ban on alcohol

Are we sleepwalking into a third world war?

FT World | 22 Oct 06:00

FT foreign editor Alec Russell speaks to Gideon Rachman about his new book

Trump exempts Russia from further sanctions mandated by new law

FT Markets | 17 Oct 11:53

US president gives Putin a reprieve on threatened energy measures after cutting deal with Moscow to release diesel

Are we sleepwalking into World War III?

FT World | 17 Oct 06:00

As regional conflicts rage and revisionist powers challenge the established order, warnings of a new global conflagration are growing louder

Markets

Equities	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,638.5	-0.33%	-0.27%
Nasdaq	26,021.5566	+0.05%	-0.45%
Dow Jones	52,302.9297	-1.07%	+0.58%
FTSE 100	10,690.3604	-0.32%	-1.76%
DAX	25,181.6504	-0.75%	-1.72%
Nikkei 225	62,907.8398	-2.65%	-2.36%
Hang Seng	22,934.6797	-3.03%	-5.67%
Euro Stoxx 50	6,068.2202	-0.31%	-2.19%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1197	-0.34%	-0.14%
GBP/USD	1.3369	-0.20%	+0.72%
USD/JPY	156.928	-0.76%	-0.77%
USD/CNY	6.6596	-0.27%	-0.47%

Bonds	Last	Day	Week
US 5Y yield	4.808	+0.84%	-1.86%
US 10Y yield	4.988	+0.71%	-2.16%
US 30Y yield	5.311	+0.45%	-2.30%

Financial sector	Last	Day	Week
US Financials (XLF)	55.925	-1.28%	+0.73%
US Banks (KBE)	65.87	+0.06%	+3.54%
Europe Financials (EUFN)	37.6803	-0.92%	-2.69%

Energy	Last	Day	Week
Brent crude	111.34	-1.62%	+1.35%
WTI crude	102.72	+3.27%	+1.29%

Natural gas	3.039	+8.69%	-2.47%

Metals	Last	Day	Week
Gold	4,015.6001	-1.10%	-3.96%
Silver	54.095	-1.22%	-5.09%
Copper	6.507	+2.27%	-0.37%

Agriculture	Last	Day	Week
Wheat	627.75	+0.48%	-4.96%
Corn	456.75	-0.81%	-3.69%
Soybeans	1,270.0	+1.36%	+0.69%
Coffee	305.9	-2.10%	+0.10%

Crypto	Last	Day	Week
Bitcoin	81,646.3906	+0.41%	-0.45%
Ethereum	2,406.21	+0.84%	-0.11%

Investment Banks	Last	Day	Week
Goldman Sachs	882.9575	-0.94%	+0.19%
Morgan Stanley	181.1696	-1.52%	+0.33%
JPMorgan	331.3279	-1.55%	-2.47%
Bank of America	50.735	-0.68%	-0.97%
Citigroup	120.87	-1.34%	-2.73%
UBS	46.44	-0.92%	-2.60%
Deutsche Bank	31.21	-0.86%	-4.18%
Barclays	21.715	-1.34%	-4.72%
HSBC	90.47	-1.55%	-4.34%
Santander	12.785	-0.89%	-3.87%
BBVA	24.795	-0.94%	-3.60%
Lazard	37.11	-0.51%	+2.83%
Evercore	252.79	-1.02%	-0.51%
Jefferies	44.63	-2.21%	-0.38%

Asset Managers & Private Equity	Last	Day	Week
BlackRock	1,115.405	-1.92%	-1.67%
Blackstone	116.755	-1.68%	+9.52%
KKR	91.78	-1.41%	+6.46%
Apollo	113.485	-1.17%	+2.44%
Carlyle	38.68	-1.33%	+6.32%
Ares Management	123.48	-0.18%	+9.98%
T. Rowe Price	104.16	+0.69%	+3.16%
Franklin Templeton	31.195	-1.03%	+0.69%
Invesco	28.43	-1.25%	+0.82%
3i Group	2,311.0	-0.13%	-6.36%
Schroders	589.0	+0.00%	+0.08%

Amundi	87.2	-0.51%	-2.02%
EQT	299.4	+1.70%	+0.44%

Exchanges & Payments	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Intercontinental Exchange	163.16	-0.42%	+0.99%
CME Group	306.7	+0.24%	+4.37%
Nasdaq Inc.	103.3	+0.00%	+9.93%
LSEG	9,510.0	+0.46%	+8.46%
Deutsche Boerse	314.1	-0.98%	+1.49%
Visa	408.645	-1.37%	+1.50%
Mastercard	621.095	-1.91%	+0.60%

Oil & Gas Majors	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
ExxonMobil	182.66	+2.49%	+2.06%
Chevron	232.5	+2.57%	+3.34%
Shell	108.03	+2.11%	+1.28%
BP	51.305	+2.51%	+2.18%
TotalEnergies	93.15	+2.41%	+1.98%
ConocoPhillips	151.5693	+4.08%	+3.45%
Equinor	48.77	+5.06%	+3.81%
Occidental	64.62	+3.39%	+3.59%
US Oil Fund (ETF)	168.3	+3.56%	+4.04%

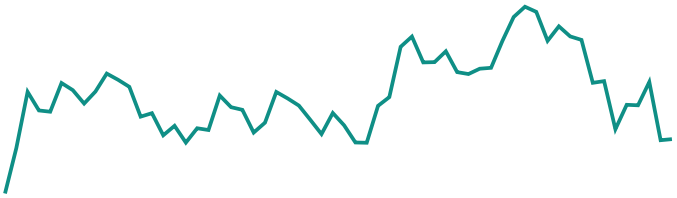
Mining & Metals	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BHP	77.71	+0.17%	-6.70%
Rio Tinto	83.415	-0.86%	-7.65%
Glencore	537.5	+0.19%	-7.82%
Freeport-McMoRan	65.325	+1.14%	-6.06%
Newmont	109.92	-3.67%	-7.32%
Vale	12.26	+0.49%	-6.13%
Gold Miners (ETF)	80.6	-1.33%	-8.11%

Big Tech & IPO Barometer	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Nvidia	211.66	-0.26%	-1.15%
Microsoft	525.27	+0.80%	-0.71%
Apple	346.645	-0.45%	+0.93%
Amazon	249.3	-0.43%	-0.28%
Alphabet	322.77	-0.45%	-5.23%
Meta	644.6001	-0.65%	-9.13%
Tesla	372.19	-0.64%	+4.93%
Renaissance IPO (ETF)	48.54	+0.79%	-0.76%

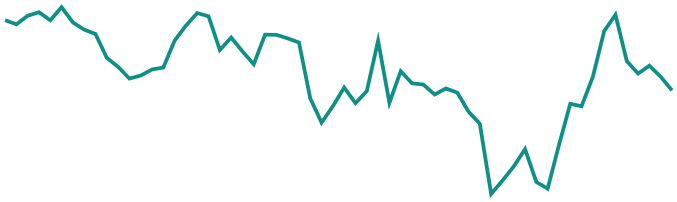
Key charts (last 60 trading days)

S&P 500: low 7489.72, high 7818.93, last 7638.5

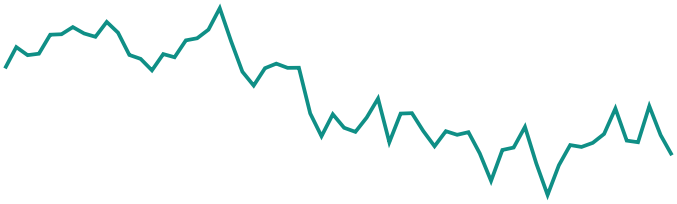
Nasdaq: low 25373.8, high 27599.8, last 26021.6



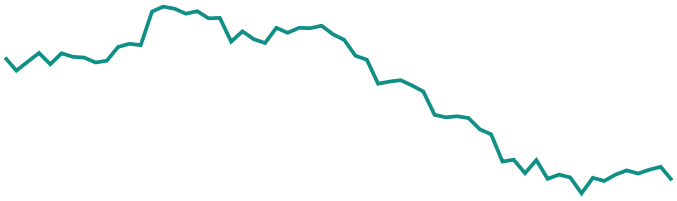
FTSE 100: low 10428.3, high 10901.1, last 10690.4



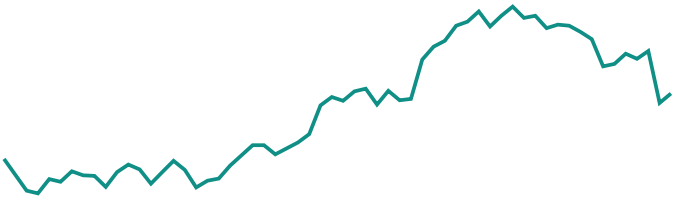
DAX: low 24807, high 26570, last 25181.7



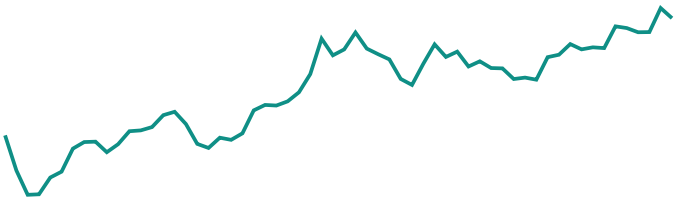
EUR/USD: low 1.116, high 1.1688, last 1.1197



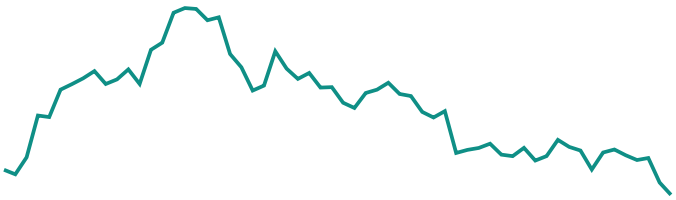
US 10Y yield: low 4.617, high 5.311, last 4.988

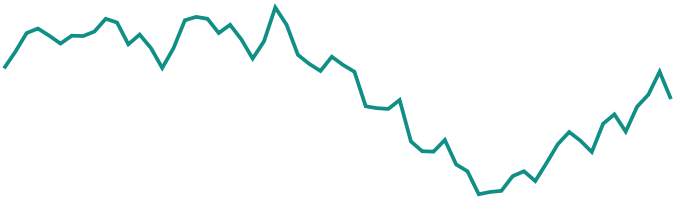


Brent crude: low 79.36, high 113.17, last 111.34



Gold: low 4015.6, high 4697.8, last 4015.6



Bitcoin: low 75612.5, high 86602.9, last 81646.4

US Financials (XLF): low 53.4, high 58.3535, last 55.925